FREQUENTLY ASKED · V0.2.9

Questions people *actually ask.*

What is Baton, in one line?

A run button you and your coding agent share: an MCP server, CLI and daemon that launch, hot-reload, read logs from and screenshot your apps, and give the agent evidence, not terminal noise.

Which apps can it run?

Flutter (real stateful hot reload), Next.js, Vite, Nuxt, Astro, Remix, Angular, React Native and Expo, native iOS (Xcode) and Android (Gradle), and any `launch.json` or `package.json` script. No new config file: it reads the ones you have.

Which agents does it work with?

Any MCP client. `baton setup` adds it in one command to Claude Code (as a plugin), Codex, Cursor, VS Code, Antigravity, Gemini CLI and Windsurf, whichever are installed. Claude Desktop's chat and other clients take a short JSON entry by hand. Agents without MCP can use the `baton` CLI.

How is this different from `flutter run` or `npm run dev` in a terminal?

The run lives in a daemon, so your terminal, the Baton app and your agent all control the same session, and closing the terminal doesn't kill it. A failed reload comes back as `lib/main.dart:419:19: Error: Expected ';'`, not "DevFS synchronization failed". And one `check_change` call tells the agent whether its edit worked.

What does `check_change` do?

It applies an edit (hot reload for Flutter, HMR for web and React Native, restart for native apps and plain processes) and answers OK or NOT OK with only what is new since the call: the reload result, error lines, failed requests and a screenshot.

Does it tap buttons or fill forms?

No. Baton launches the app and reports evidence; it does not tap the UI or judge screenshots. For input, pair it with Playwright MCP or Chrome DevTools MCP for web, or a device-control MCP such as mobile-mcp for simulators. Baton gives them the URL or the booted device.

Can it screenshot web apps?

Yes. It opens the session URL in a throwaway headless Chrome-family browser at `phone` (390×844), `tablet`, `desktop` or `WIDTHxHEIGHT`, and returns the page's console errors and failed requests with the image. That needs Chrome, Chromium, Edge or Brave installed, or `BATON_CHROME` set to a browser binary.

Can my agent start a simulator?

Yes: `boot_device` with a name like "iPhone 17 Pro" boots an iOS simulator or Android emulator and returns the id for `run_target`. With no name it lists what can boot.

MORE ANSWERS

Setup, safety *and the band.*

Is it safe? It runs commands.

It only launches targets from your own launch configs and package scripts. The daemon listens on loopback (127.0.0.1) only and authenticates with a token in `~/.baton/daemon.json`, a file with mode 0600. Nothing leaves your machine: no account, no cloud service, and it's free and open source (MIT). Don't expose the port, and keep secrets out of launch files you commit.

Why Node 24?

Baton requires Node.js 24 or newer; it's the version it's built and tested on. `nvm install 24` takes a minute. Restart your agent afterwards so it picks up the new Node.

Which platforms?

macOS, Linux and Windows. iOS simulators need a Mac, as always. A few controls use macOS itself: Pause and Bring to front.

What is the band in Claude Code?

With the plugin, a row per run sits above the prompt in the terminal and the desktop app, with ☰ logs, 🐞 debug (Claude reads the errors and fixes them), ▶ play/reload, ⏸ pause, ■ stop and ⧉ bring to front. The header has + new run and the same buttons for every run at once. `/baton` opens it in a pane.

Why is Pause greyed out?

Pause is macOS only. It covers iOS simulators and local processes such as dev servers; Android emulators can't be paused from the band.

I have an iPhone and an iPad simulator. Which one does Bring to front show?

The one on that row. ⧉ opens Simulator and then asks it to show that run's own device, the same signal Xcode sends, so the iPad's row brings the iPad forward. ⧉ in the header raises every run's window. For a web run it opens the URL. macOS only.

I added Baton to Codex, but "run my app" doesn't use it.

Codex keeps MCP tools out of the prompt until it searches for them. Install the Codex plugin (`codex plugin marketplace add kanumuri9593/Baton`, then `codex plugin add baton@baton`): its skills are what lead Codex to Baton.

How do I uninstall?

`baton setup --remove` takes Baton out of every agent (name one to limit it, e.g. `baton setup --remove cursor`). Files it edited keep a `.baton-backup`. Then `npm uninstall -g baton-run`.

Something broke. Where do I report it?

Run `/baton:doctor` or `baton doctor` first. Then open an issue at github.com/kanumuri9593/Baton/issues with your OS, Node version and agent.